

PLANNING AREA

A **Planning Area** is:

- A logical or physical boundary
- Within which planning processes are carried out
- Using specific data structures, rules, and objectives

Planning Area is a central data structure used in demand planning (DP) and supply network planning (SNP). It acts as a framework that defines how planning data is stored, structured, and accessed. It is one of the most critical configuration elements in APO because it determines how planning is performed and how data is organized.

A Planning Area in SAP APO is a multidimensional data structure that stores planning data (such as forecasts, sales, inventory, etc.) using characteristics and key figures. It organizes this data in a way that allows planners to perform forecasting, analysis, and simulations efficiently.

Planning Area is a place where planning data is stored and forecast is being calculated. A **Planning Area** is a defined scope or boundary within which planning activities, data, and decisions are organized and managed.

Key Characteristics

- Defines what is being planned
- Defines where planning applies
- Structures data and decision-making
- Helps in segmentation and analysis

Planning Area is a blueprint of planning Logic; it acts like a container for planning data. Planning Area consists of MPOS, CVC ,Time bucket Profile ,Storage bucket profile and many others

Key Figures Explained

Key figures represent numerical data used in planning. Examples include:

- Historical sales
- Forecast quantities
- Promotion quantities
- Inventory levels

They can be either stored (physically saved) or calculated using formulas.

Concept	Meaning
Planning Area	Defines how data is structured and stored (backend data model)
Planning Book	Defines how data is displayed and edited (user interface)

Planning Book

Planning Book is an UI tool where the planners can view, analyse, and modify the data which is stored in Planning Area.

Planning Book contains data views, multiple data views can be contained, Each data view are designed for specific tasks and for specific work.

Eg: Monthly Forecast View

Weekly Sales View

Promotion Planning View

Transaction Code: /SAPAPO/SDP94

A **Planning Book** is the **front-end user interface** in SAP APO where planners:

- View planning data
- Perform forecasting
- Adjust values manually

Core Components

1. Data Views (Most Important Concept)

- Each Planning Book contains **multiple data views**
- Defines:
 - Which key figures appear
 - Layout of the screen

Example:

- Forecast view
- Sales analysis view
- Promotion view

2. Time Axis (Columns)

Defines time buckets:

- Daily
- Weekly
- Monthly

Example: | Key Figure | Jan | Feb | Mar |

3. Display Settings

Controls:

- Aggregation level
 - Decimal formatting
 - Units (EA, KG, etc.)
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4. Layout & Design

Defines:

- Tab structure
- Screen organization
- Fonts/colors (limited)

Data View

A Data View is a specific layout or screen used to display planning data in a structured way for analysis and decision-making.

A Data View is a customized layout within a Planning Book that defines how planning data (key figures and time) is displayed to the user.

Realignment

Realignment in SAP APO is a process used to move or reassign planning data from one characteristic combination to another within a Planning Area.

Why Realignment is Needed

In real business scenarios, master data changes frequently, for example:

- Product reassigned to a new region
- Customer moved to a different sales group
- Product hierarchy changes
- New product replaces an old product